

Software Architecture & Design Specification

Smart Lab Equipment & Slot Reservation Portal

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Author	Anagha N (PES1UG24CS058)
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Inputs	SRS.md (SRS-SLP-01)
Part I	Architecture: §1–§7. Part II – Design: §8–§12

Status. This is a *design for a system that is not yet implemented*. Technology products are deliberately not named because Lab 1 did not choose any (SRS A-01). Where the SRS is silent, a labelled design decision (DD-xx) is made and listed in §12 for confirmation.

1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose and scope

Describe the structure of the portal and the detailed design needed to implement SRS-SLP-01: components and their responsibilities, how security requirements are realised, the HTTP API, the interaction of components in two key use cases, and error handling.

1.2 References

SRS (SRS.md), Test Plan (Test_Plan.md), Traceability (traceability/Requirements_Traceability.md), Lab 1 documents (see SRS §1.4).

1.3 Definitions

IDs follow the SRS: FR/NFR/SEC-REQ/UC. **C-nn** = architecture component, **SD-nn** = sequence diagram, **DD-nn** = design decision.

Part I – Architecture

2. Architectural Drivers

Driver	Source	Consequence for the architecture
No double booking, even under simultaneous requests	FR-001, NFR-003	One authoritative store with transactional locking; all reservation writes in a single locked transaction.
Reservation processed in ≤ 200 ms	NFR-001	Short transaction; no slow external call inside it (DD-04).
Role-restricted functions, session expiry	NFR-002, SEC-REQ-01/02	Central authentication and authorization components that every request passes through.
Student-own-data access	SEC-REQ-03	Ownership checks in the reservation logic.
Input validation	SEC-REQ-05	Single validating entry point (API layer) plus parameterised data access.
Accountability	SEC-REQ-06	Dedicated audit component.
External notification, failure-tolerant	FR-009, A-06	Adapter component isolating the external system.
Calibration check as a distinct rule	FR-002, FR-008	Separate component with one responsibility, reused by reservation.

3. Architecture Pattern

Selected pattern: layered client–server architecture (three tiers: web client / application server / relational database), with a service-oriented decomposition of the business layer.

Structure derived from the actual system: - Users work through a browser portal → a **client tier** (C-01). - All business rules (calibration, overlap, cut-off, penalty, RBAC) must be enforced centrally and cannot be trusted to the browser (NFR-002, SEC-REQ-05) → an **application-server tier** (C-02...C-10) exposing an HTTP/JSON API. - NFR-001/NFR-003 explicitly call for *database-level lock isolation*, i.e. a transactional relational store that is the single source of truth → a **data tier** (C-11, C-12). - Inside the server the layers are: API layer (entry, validation, security filter) → business services (reservation, calibration, inventory, return/penalty) → data access layer. Cross-cutting components (authentication, access control, audit, notification adapter) are separate so that each security requirement maps to one component.

Why not alternatives: *MVC* describes the internal structure of a UI application rather than the system-level split between browser, server and database, so it is not used as the system pattern (the web client may use it internally, which is not constrained here). *Microservices* would add distributed transactions that conflict with the single-transaction locking required by NFR-003, and the scale (one lab) does not justify it. *Event-driven/publish-subscribe* is not needed: the only asynchronous interaction is the one notification request (DD-04).

4. Component View

4.1 Component diagram

Component Diagram - Smart Lab Equipment & Slot Reservation Portal

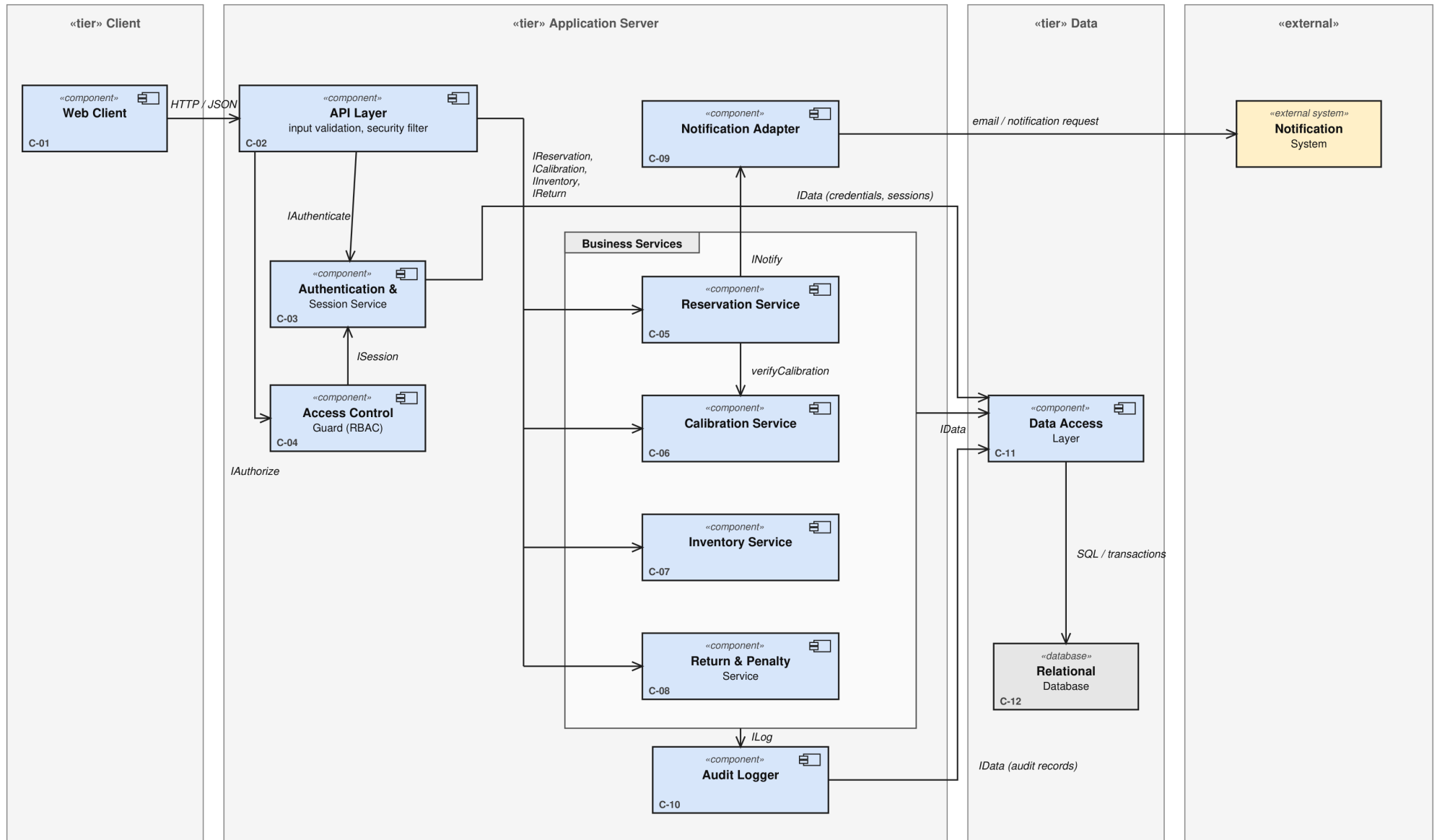


Figure 2 – UML Component Diagram (draw.io source: diagrams/component.drawio)

Dashed arrows are UML dependencies (the arrow points to the component that provides the interface). The *Business Services* package groups C-05...C-08; arrows crossing its border apply to the contained services as listed in the table.

4.2 Component descriptions

ID	Component	Responsibility	Provided interface / depends on	Related requirements
C-01	Web Client	Browser UI for all use cases; shows role-specific menus; displays error messages; never enforces rules on its own.	Uses HTTP/JSON API of C-02.	UC-01...UC-08 UI; EIR-01; FR-001, FR-003, FR-007, FR-009 (display)
C-02	API Layer	Single entry point: routes requests, runs the security filter (session present, not expired → C-03; role allowed → C-04), validates inputs, maps component results and exceptions to HTTP responses (§11).	Provides HTTP/JSON API (§9). Uses IAuthenticate (C-03), IAuthorize (C-04), IReservation, ICalibration, IInventory, IReturn.	SEC-REQ-04, SEC-REQ-05, NFR-001 (request handling), EIR-04
C-03	Authentication & Session Service	Verifies credentials, issues a session token bound to user and role, tracks last activity and expires sessions after 30 min inactivity.	Provides IAuthenticate, ISession. Uses C-11 (credentials, sessions).	FR-006, NFR-002, SEC-REQ-02, SEC-REQ-04
C-04	Access Control Guard (RBAC)	Decides whether the role in the session may call an operation (technician-only vs student-only).	Provides IAuthorize. Uses ISession (C-03).	NFR-002, SEC-REQ-01, SEC-REQ-03 (role part)
C-05	Reservation Service	Availability query; reserve (duration, horizon, overlap, own-overlap); token generation; cancel (ownership, cut-off, release); own history. Runs the reservation transaction.	Provides IReservation. Uses ICalibration (C-06), INotify (C-09), IData (C-11).	FR-001, FR-003, FR-007, FR-010, NFR-001, NFR-003, SEC-REQ-03; UC-02...UC-05, UC-10
C-06	Calibration Service	Verifies calibration status (UC-09) and updates it (UC-07).	Provides ICalibration. Uses IData, ILog.	FR-002, FR-008, SEC-REQ-06
C-07	Inventory Service	Add / update / remove equipment records; refuses removal with future Confirmed reservations (DD-06).	Provides IInventory. Uses IData, ILog.	FR-005, SEC-REQ-05, SEC-REQ-06
C-08	Return & Penalty Service	Records returns, computes the late-return flag (UC-12).	Provides IReturn. Uses IData, ILog.	FR-004, SEC-REQ-06
C-09	Notification Adapter	Builds and submits the confirmation request to the external Notification System; logs failures without failing the reservation.	Provides INotify. Uses the Notification System.	FR-009, EIR-02, A-06
C-10	Audit Logger	Writes audit records for privileged actions; also receives error log entries (§11.4).	Provides ILog. Uses IData (audit records).	SEC-REQ-06, SEC-OBJ-04
C-11	Data Access Layer	All persistence; transactions and slot/row locks; parameterised statements only.	Provides IData. Uses C-12 over SQL.	NFR-001, NFR-003, SEC-REQ-05, EIR-03
C-12	Relational Database	Stores users, sessions, equipment, reservations, audit records; provides transactions and locking.	SQL.	NFR-003, EIR-03
EXT	Notification System (external)	Delivers email / notification. Not part of the system.	Used by C-09.	FR-009

Every component has at least one related requirement; no requirement is without a component (§5).

5. Traceability: Requirements → Use Cases → Components → Design

Requirement	Use case	Components	Design elements	Tests
FR-001	UC-02, UC-03, UC-10	C-01, C-02, C-05, C-11, C-12	SD-01; API GET /equipment/{id}/availability, POST /reservations; DD-01, DD-02	TC-01–04, 17, 21
FR-002	UC-03, UC-09	C-05, C-06, C-11	SD-01 (alt A1); 409 CALIBRATION_INVALID	TC-01, 05, 13
FR-003	UC-04	C-05, C-11	API POST /reservations/{id}/cancel; DD-05	TC-06, 07, 23
FR-004	UC-06, UC-12	C-08, C-10, C-11	SD-02; API POST /reservations/{id}/return	TC-08, 09, 22
FR-005	UC-08	C-07, C-10, C-11	API POST/PUT/DELETE /equipment; DD-06	TC-10, 21, 22
FR-006	UC-01	C-03, C-11	API POST /auth/login	TC-11, 19, 20
FR-007	UC-05	C-05, C-11	API GET /reservations/me	TC-12
FR-008	UC-07	C-06, C-10, C-11	API PUT /equipment/{id}/calibration	TC-13, 22
FR-009	UC-11	C-05, C-09	SD-01; DD-04	TC-14
FR-010	UC-03	C-05, C-11	SD-01 (overlap check, both windows)	TC-15
NFR-001	UC-03	C-02, C-05, C-11	DD-02, DD-04	TC-16
NFR-002	UC-06/07/08	C-03, C-04, C-02	SD-02 (security filter); §7	TC-18, 19
NFR-003	UC-03	C-05, C-11, C-12	DD-02; SD-01	TC-17
SEC-REQ-01...06	–	see §7	see §7	TC-11, 12, 18–23

6. Data View

Logical entities (technology-neutral):

Entity	Attributes	Notes
User	id, username, role (Student / Lab Technician), credential verifier	Credential verifier is not a plain-text password (SEC-REQ-04); algorithm is an implementation choice.
Session	token, userId, role, lastActivity	Valid while now – lastActivity ≤ 30 min (SEC-REQ-02).
Equipment	id, name, category, calibrationStatus (Valid / Expired / Pending), calibrationDueDate	FR-005, FR-008, A-02.
Reservation	id, studentId, equipmentId, slotStart, slotEnd, status (Confirmed / Cancelled / Returned), token (unique), createdAt, returnTimestamp, penaltyFlag	FR-001, 003, 004.
AuditRecord	id, userId, role, action, targetId, timestamp	SEC-REQ-06.

Relationships: a User (Student) has many Reservations; Equipment has many Reservations. Constraint: the database shall not allow two Confirmed reservations of the same equipment with overlapping slots (enforced by the locked transaction of DD-02; a database-level exclusion/uniqueness rule can be added as defence in depth if the chosen database supports it).

7. Security Architecture

7.1 Trust boundaries

Browser (untrusted) → API Layer (first trusted point: security filter and validation) → services → data. The Notification System is outside the boundary and receives only the confirmation data of FR-009. Nothing the browser sends (role, student id, times) is trusted: role and user id come from the server-side session, never from the request body.

7.2 Security requirement → control → mechanism → validation

Security objective	Requirement	Component(s) / control	Design mechanism	Validation
SEC-OBJ-01	SEC-REQ-01	C-04 Access Control Guard, invoked by C-02 for every operation	Static operation → allowed-roles table; technician-only: calibration, inventory, return, list-all-reservations; deny by default; 403 FORBIDDEN_ROLE.	TC-18
SEC-OBJ-01	SEC-REQ-02	C-03	lastActivity updated on every valid request; request rejected if now – lastActivity > 30 min; 401 SESSION_EXPIRED.	TC-19
SEC-OBJ-01	SEC-REQ-04	C-03, C-02 security filter	Every endpoint except POST /auth/login requires a valid session token; login returns one generic error for unknown user and wrong password; credentials stored only as a verifier and excluded from logs (C-10 / §11.4).	TC-11, TC-20
SEC-OBJ-03	SEC-REQ-03	C-05 (+ C-04 for role)	Ownership check reservation.studentId == session.userId before read or cancel; 403 FORBIDDEN_RESOURCE with no reservation data in the body. History query is filtered by the session's user id, not by a client-supplied id.	TC-12, TC-23
SEC-OBJ-02	SEC-REQ-05	C-02 input validation; C-11	Schema validation (type, format, range) before any service call; parameterised statements only in C-11; server-side horizon / duration rules.	TC-21
SEC-OBJ-04	SEC-REQ-06	C-10	Services C-06, C-07, C-08 call ILog after a successful privileged action, recording user id, role, action, target, time (same transaction as the change, DD-07).	TC-22
SEC-OBJ-02	NFR-003 (integrity)	C-05, C-11, C-12	Locked transaction for reservation writes.	TC-17

Deployment assumption A-10 (HTTPS) protects session tokens in transit; it is a configuration dependency, not a component.

Part II – Design

8. Design Decisions

ID	Decision	Rationale / requirement	Needs confirmation?
DD-01	A Reservation Token is a random, non-guessable identifier generated server-side and stored with a uniqueness constraint; it is bound to the reservation row (student, equipment, slot). Exact format/length is an implementation choice.	FR-001 "unique token bound to student, equipment, slot"; UC-10.	Format only
DD-02	The reservation write is a single database transaction: lock the student row and then the equipment row (fixed order, avoids deadlock) → re-read calibration status → check overlap for equipment window and student window → insert → commit. Concurrent requests for the same equipment are serialised by the lock.	NFR-003, NFR-001, FR-010	No
DD-03	Times are compared in one server time base; the slot window is <code>[slotStart, slotEnd)</code> , so back-to-back slots do not overlap.	FR-001, TC-04	Yes (A-05)
DD-04	The request to the Notification System is submitted after the transaction commits and a failure never rolls back the reservation; it is logged.	A-06, NFR-001 (no external call inside the timed path or the lock)	Yes (A-06)
DD-05	Cancel: allowed when <code>now ≤ slotStart - 60 min</code> ; sets status Cancelled; the slot is free immediately on commit (well inside the 5 s of FR-003).	FR-003, A-04	Yes (A-04)
DD-06	Removing equipment with future Confirmed reservations is rejected (409 <code>EQUIPMENT_HAS_ACTIVE_RESERVATIONS</code>).	FR-005, A-07	Yes (A-07)
DD-07	Audit records are written in the same transaction as the privileged change, so a change without audit record cannot be committed.	SEC-REQ-06	No
DD-08	Role and user id are taken from the server-side session, never from request parameters.	SEC-REQ-01/03	No

9. API Design

The portal exposes an HTTP/JSON API consumed by its own web client (C-01). Base path `/api/v1`. Content type `application/json`. All endpoints except `POST /auth/login` require header `Authorization: Bearer <session token>` (SEC-REQ-04). Timestamps are ISO-8601. Role column: S = Student, T = Lab Technician.

9.1 Endpoint catalogue

#	Method & path	Purpose	Role	Use case	Requirement
1	POST /auth/login	Authenticate, create session	public	UC-01	FR-006
2	GET /equipment?category=&calibrationStatus=	List equipment with calibration status	S, T	UC-02	FR-001
3	GET /equipment/{id}/availability?from=&to=	Reserved / free slots of one item	S, T	UC-02	FR-001
4	POST /equipment	Add equipment	T	UC-08	FR-005
5	PUT /equipment/{id}	Update equipment	T	UC-08	FR-005
6	DELETE /equipment/{id}	Remove equipment	T	UC-08	FR-005
7	PUT /equipment/{id}/calibration	Set calibration status	T	UC-07	FR-008
8	POST /reservations	Reserve a slot	S	UC-03	FR-001, 002, 009, 010
9	GET /reservations/me	Own reservation history	S	UC-05	FR-007
10	GET /reservations/{id}	One reservation (owner or technician)	S (owner), T	UC-05	FR-007, SEC-REQ-03
11	POST /reservations/{id}/cancel	Cancel own reservation	S (owner)	UC-04	FR-003
12	GET /reservations?status=Confirmed	List reservations to process returns	T	UC-06	FR-004
13	POST /reservations/{id}/return	Record return, set penalty flag	T	UC-06, UC-12	FR-004

No other API exists; endpoint 12 is a design addition so that a technician can select "the reserved item" of UC-06.

9.2 Details of the main endpoints

1. POST /auth/login – Request { "username": "string", "password": "string" }. Success 200 { "token": "...", "role": "Student|Lab Technician", "expiresAfterIdleMinutes": 30 }. Errors: 400 VALIDATION_ERROR (missing field), 401 INVALID_CREDENTIALS (same body for unknown user and wrong password). Not authenticated by design.

2. GET /equipment – Success 200 { "items": [{ "id": 1, "name": "...", "category": "...", "calibrationStatus": "Valid", "calibrationDueDate": "2026-12-31" }] }. Errors: 401, 400 (unknown filter value).

3. GET /equipment/{id}/availability – Success 200 { "equipmentId": 1, "reserved": [{ "start": "...", "end": "..." }] }. Errors: 401, 404 EQUIPMENT_NOT_FOUND, 400.

4–6. Equipment maintenance (T) – POST /equipment body { "name", "category", "calibrationDueDate" } → 201 with the record; PUT /equipment/{id} same body → 200; DELETE /equipment/{id} → 200. Errors: 401, 403 FORBIDDEN_ROLE, 404, 422/400 validation, 409 EQUIPMENT_HAS_ACTIVE_RESERVATIONS (delete only).

7. PUT /equipment/{id}/calibration – Request { "status": "Valid|Expired|Pending" } → 200 updated record. Errors: 401, 403, 404, 422 INVALID_CALIBRATION_STATUS.

8. POST /reservations – Request { "equipmentId": 1, "start": "2026-10-02T10:00:00", "durationMinutes": 90 }. Student id comes from the session (DD-08). Success 201 { "reservationId": 17, "token": "...", "equipmentId": 1, "start": "...", "end": "...", "status": "Confirmed" }. Errors:

HTTP	Code	Condition
400	VALIDATION_ERROR	missing / non-numeric / malformed field
422	DURATION_EXCEEDS_LIMIT	duration > 120 min (or ≤ 0 → VALIDATION_ERROR)
422	START_OUT_OF_RANGE	start in the past or later than now + 7 days
401 / 403	AUTHENTICATION_REQUIRED, SESSION_EXPIRED, FORBIDDEN_ROLE	filter
404	EQUIPMENT_NOT_FOUND	unknown equipment
409	CALIBRATION_INVALID	status Expired / Pending; body carries the FR-002 message and alternatives
409	SLOT_CONFLICT	overlap on equipment; body carries nextAvailableSlots
409	STUDENT_SLOT_CONFLICT	student has an overlapping reservation (FR-010)

9. GET /reservations/me – Success 200 { "items": [{ "id", "equipment", "start", "end", "status", "token", "penaltyFlag" }] } (only the caller's records). Errors: 401, 403.

10. GET /reservations/{id} – Success 200 one item. Errors: 401, 403 FORBIDDEN_RESOURCE (student, not owner), 404 RESERVATION_NOT_FOUND.

11. POST /reservations/{id}/cancel – No body. Success 200 { "reservationId", "status": "Cancelled" }. Errors: 401, 403 FORBIDDEN_RESOURCE, 404, 409 CANCELLATION_WINDOW_CLOSED (less than 60 min to start), 409 INVALID_RESERVATION_STATE (already Cancelled / Returned).

12. GET /reservations?status=Confirmed – Success 200 list (all students) for technicians. Errors: 401, 403.

13. POST /reservations/{id}/return – No body; technician id from the session. Success 200 { "reservationId", "status": "Returned", "returnTimestamp": "...", "penaltyFlag": true|false }. Errors: 401, 403 FORBIDDEN_ROLE, 400 (malformed id), 404 RESERVATION_NOT_FOUND, 409 INVALID_RESERVATION_STATE.

9.3 Common error body

```
{ "error": { "code": "SLOT_CONFLICT", "message": "Human-readable text", "details": { } } }
```

message is safe to show to the user; details carries structured data (alternatives, next slots, field errors). No stack traces or internal identifiers are returned.

10. Sequence Diagrams

The two sequence diagrams model use cases UC-03 (the core use case specified in Lab 1) and UC-06 (the technician-side use case that exercises RBAC, the extend relationship and auditing).

10.1 SD-01 – UC-03 Reserve Equipment Slot

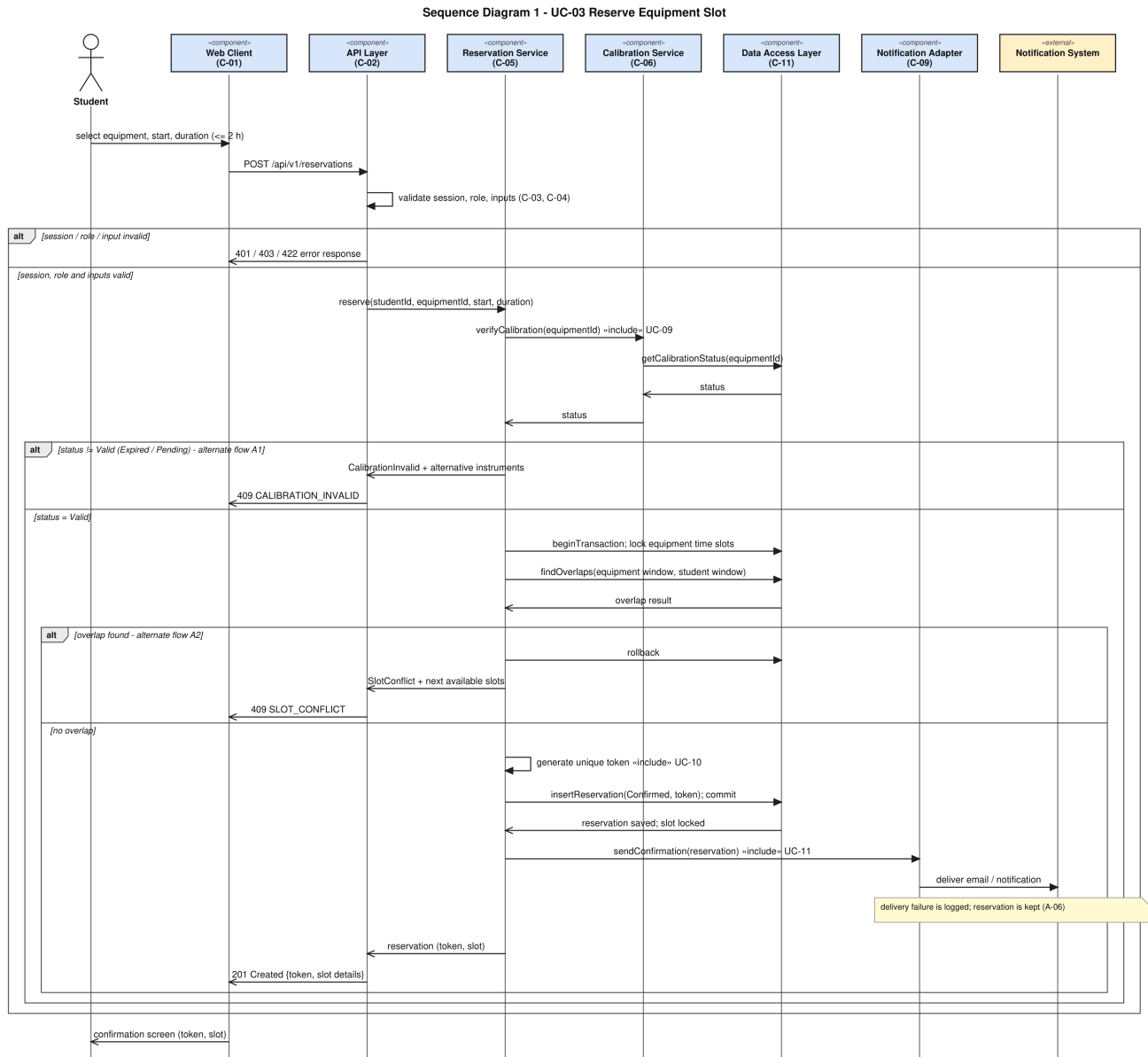


Figure 3 – Sequence Diagram 1: Reserve Equipment Slot (draw.io source: diagrams/sequence-01.drawio)

Covers: FR-001, FR-002, FR-009, FR-010, NFR-001, NFR-003; alternate flows A1 (calibration), A2 (conflict), A3 (invalid session/input); the «include» use cases UC-09, UC-10, UC-11. Steps 4–5 of the Lab 1 flow (calibration, overlap) appear in the same order. The overlap check and the insert happen inside one locked transaction (DD-02). The request to the Notification System is submitted after commit (DD-04).

10.2 SD-02 – UC-06 Return Equipment

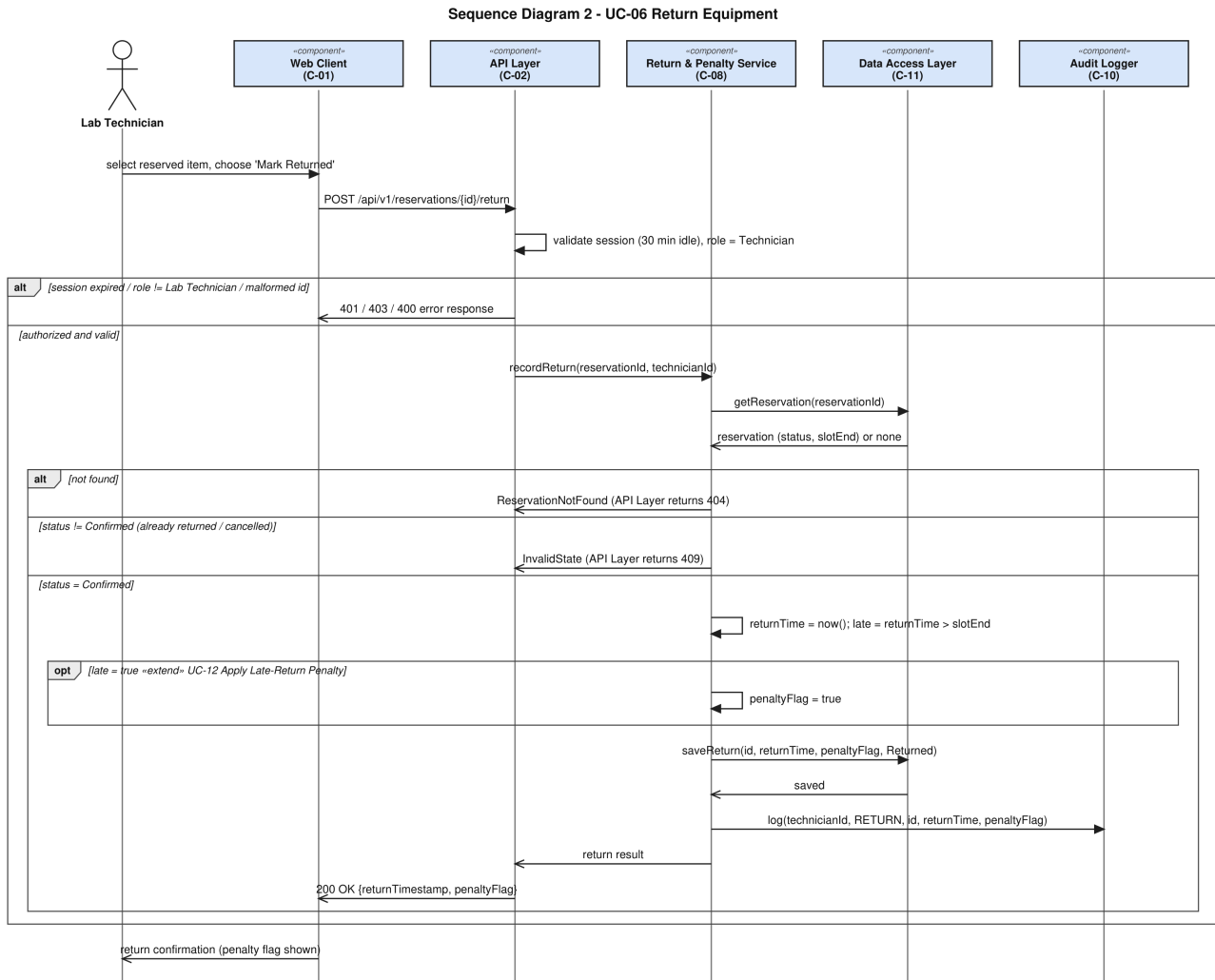


Figure 4 – Sequence Diagram 2: Return Equipment (draw.io source: diagrams/sequence-02.drawio)

Covers: FR-004, NFR-002, SEC-REQ-01, SEC-REQ-02, SEC-REQ-06; the «extend» use case UC-12 appears as the **opt** fragment taken only when `returnTime > slotEnd`. The security filter rejects expired sessions (401) and non-technician roles (403) before the service is called.

11. Error Handling

11.1 Principles

1. Validate early (API Layer) and fail with a precise code; never let invalid input reach the data layer (SEC-REQ-05).
2. A failed request changes no data: reservation, cancellation, return and inventory operations run in one transaction that is rolled back on any failure (FR-001 postcondition "no reservation record is created").
3. Messages for users are specific enough to act on but never reveal internals, other users' data, or whether a username exists.
4. The same error body format is used everywhere (§9.3).

11.2 Error categories

Category	Examples	HTTP	User-facing behaviour	System behaviour
Invalid input	non-numeric id, duration ≤ 0 , missing field, bad status value	400 / 422	Field-level message; form stays filled	No state change; logged at INFO with request id
Business-rule violation	duration > 120, start > 7 d, overlap, student overlap, cancel inside cut-off, invalid state	422 / 409	Message from SRS (e.g. FR-002 wording); alternatives or next slots shown	Transaction rolled back; INFO log
Calibration not valid	Expired / Pending	409 CALIBRATION_INVALID	"This equipment is currently unavailable for booking — calibration required." + alternative instruments	No reservation created
Missing data	unknown equipment or reservation id; no alternatives available	404 or empty list	"Not found" message; empty-list message in UI	None
Authentication failure	no / malformed token, expired session, wrong credentials	401	Redirect to login; generic "invalid credentials" text	Log with source and time; never log the password
Authorization failure	Student calls technician function; access to another student's reservation	403	"You are not allowed to perform this action."	Log WARN (user id, endpoint); no data changed or disclosed
Resource unavailable	database down or lock wait too long	503 SERVICE_UNAVAILABLE	"Service temporarily unavailable, please retry."	Transaction rolled back; ERROR log; no partial reservation. (Lock-wait limit is an implementation setting, not specified by the SRS.)
External system failure	Notification System unreachable	none (request succeeds)	Reservation confirmed; on-screen confirmation still shown	Failure logged by C-09; reservation kept (A-06). No retry policy is specified.
Unexpected error	unhandled exception	500 INTERNAL_ERROR	Generic message with a request id	Transaction rolled back; ERROR log with stack trace (server side only)

11.3 Concurrency errors

When two requests compete for a slot, the one that loses the lock re-checks and receives 409 SLOT_CONFLICT – not a 500 (TC-17).

11.4 Logging strategy

- **Audit log (C-10):** privileged successful actions (SEC-REQ-06). Persistent, in the database.
- **Application log:** timestamp, request id, user id (if any), endpoint, outcome / error code. Never contains passwords, tokens or full request bodies.
- Authentication failures and authorization failures are logged; log retention and rotation are not specified by Lab 1.

12. Open Issues and Items Needing Confirmation

ID	Item	Where used
A-02	Calibration status is a stored field; due date does not auto-expire it.	FR-002, FR-008, DD
A-03	Peak load for NFR-001 (20 concurrent requests used for testing only).	TC-16
A-04, A-05	Cancel cut-off inclusive; whole-minute slots, no minimum duration.	DD-03, DD-05
A-06	Notification failure keeps the reservation.	DD-04, TC-14
A-07	Equipment with future reservations cannot be removed.	DD-06
A-10	HTTPS in deployment; password-verifier algorithm not chosen.	\$7
–	Technology stack, hosting, and Notification System protocol not chosen.	whole document